3. Sources and importance of Creativity and Innovation

by

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Date: November 11, 2026

Objectives

At the end of this subsection, the trainees will be able to:

- ✓ Identify the sources of creativity and innovation
- ✓ analyze the importance of creativity and innovation,
- ✓ identify institutional arrangements and practices that facilitate the implementation of creative and innovation-oriented projects and programs, and
- ✓ implement institutional arrangements and practice improvements that are suitable for the implementation of creative and innovation-oriented projects and programs.

Training outlines

- Sources of creativity and innovation
- Importance of creativity and innovation
- Understanding the impacts of creativity and innovation

3.1. Sources of creativity and innovation

Creativity and changes are influenced by a variety of sources.

The **sources of creativity** and change can be personal experiences, cultural influences, social interactions environmental factors, technology and tools, education and learning, growth mindset and divergent thinking, economic and political contexts, global trends and accidental discoveries.

Hence, individuals and organizations can enhance their creative capabilities and drive meaningful change by tapping into these diverse sources.

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The sources of innovations can be the followings:

- ✓ A recurring problem in the work unit,
- ✓ Exposure to new ideas and trends,
- ✓ Continually scan the media for interesting or unusual trends,
- ✓ Encourage innovation by respecting views of individuals
- ✓ Interview customers, and listen to other people’s opinions and suggestions,
- ✓ Seek out creative thinkers and talk with them to generate new ideas that can be applied in the work unit, and
- ✓ Research how new technologies are being used and applied in different industries.

3.2. Importance of creativity and innovation

Creativity helps an employee to adapt new processes, and changes in legislation/ public policy, ensuring he/she remains competent in a dynamic work environment.

It encourages an employee to be up-to-date related with their roles to facilitate public service deliveries.

Innovation improves competitive advantage, increase efficiency, enhanced customer experience, economic growth, address social challenges, cultural advancement, sustainability, employee engagement and skill development, improve problem solving and improve future preparedness with proactive mindset.

Activity 3.1: Group discussion

Dear trainees, please discuss in groups on the following discussion points, and present your reflections.

1. Identify the factors that influence the sources of creativity and innovation for individuals and organizations, and present your reflection.
2. Identify the importance of creativity and innovation.
3. Explain the effects of institutional arrangements and practices on creativity and innovation.
4. Demonstrate institutional arrangements and practices that facilitate the implementation of creative and innovative projects/ programs.

3.3. Understanding the impacts of creativity and innovation

Understanding the impact of creativity involves recognizing how innovative ideas and transformations influence individuals, organizations, and society as a whole.

- The impact of creativity can be personal development, organizational growth, cultural revolution, social change, psychological benefits and educational impact.
- The impact of creativity shapes individual identities, fuels organizational success, fosters cultural richness, and inspires social progress.
- Thus, individuals and organizations can harness creativity as a powerful tool for positive transformation in various aspects by understanding impacts of creativity and change.

Activity 3.2: Group discussion

Dear trainees, please discuss in groups on the following discussion points, and present your reflections.

1. Identify the impacts of creativity and innovation on individuals, organizations and community.
2. Explain how to improve institutional arrangements and practices that are suitable for the implementation of creative and innovation projects and programs.
3. Explain how to implement institutional arrangements and practice improvements that are suitable for the implementation of creative and innovation-oriented projects and programs.

Summary

Creativity and innovation have impacts on **individuals**, **organizations**, and **communities**.

- Creativity and innovation have an **impact on individuals**' personal growth in self-expression and personal development, career advancement, mental well-being and adaptability.
- Creativity and innovation have **impacts on organizations** competitive advantage, efficiency, employee engagement, attracting talent, and sustainability and social responsibility.
- Creativity and innovation have **impacts on communities**' economic development, social cohesion, cultural enrichment, and problem solving and resilience challenges.

Thank You!